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Story Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe a **journey, process, use case, activity sequence, or business story**.

This guide is about **what happens, who is involved, what changes, and what outcome is reached**.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **business journeys and scenarios**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas

Blueprint Bundle

Metamodel Vocabulary

Migrations

DESIGN

Architecture

Concepts

Domain

Dynamics

Infrastructure

Interactions

Models

Quality

Rules

Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability

Decisions

Motivation

Organization

Roadmap

Leverage

Test Cases

Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



Main entities in this guide

- **Story** — a full business journey or scenario from trigger to outcome.
- **Activity** — a meaningful chunk of work inside a story; steps live inside the activity.
- **User Story** — a concise user-centered need, often phrased as value for an actor.
- **Use Case** — a structured interaction goal with actors, trigger, and expected result.
 - Often confused with: **Transition** in the Rules guide. A story activity or step tells the journey; a transition tells which state change is allowed.

What belongs here

Capture things like:

- a user journey
- a business process
- a service flow
- a use case
- a sequence of activities and steps
- success, error, and exception paths

What does not belong here

- full definitions of business concepts — put those in the Concepts guide
- detailed screen behavior — put that in the Interactions guide
- formal rules and constraints — describe them here only briefly and link them conceptually

Core things to capture

Describe:

- **who** starts the story
- **why** the story exists
- **what activities** happen
- **what steps** happen inside those activities
- **what triggers** the next part
- **what success looks like**
- **what can go wrong**
- **what other concepts, screens, or rules are involved**

Core relationships to capture

Make these links explicit in your text:

- actor -> story
- story -> activity
- activity -> step
- step -> next step or next activity
- story -> concepts involved
- story -> screens/interactions involved
- story -> outcomes, risks, or rules that matter

Modus operandi

When eliciting a story, work in this order:

1. name the **goal**
2. identify the **actor**
3. describe the **main happy path**
4. split the flow into **activities**
5. add important **steps** inside each activity
6. add **exceptions, errors, and alternate paths**
7. list the concepts and screens involved

Focus on the business meaning of the flow, not on technical implementation.

Prompt set

Use questions like these:

- who wants something to happen?

- what starts the flow?
- what is the first meaningful activity?
- what happens next, and why?
- what is the expected outcome?
- what can fail?
- what other people or systems take part?
- what business concepts are changed, read, or created?

Free-text intake template

Use this template when gathering notes:

- **Story name:**
- **Goal:**
- **Primary actor(s):**
- **Trigger:**
- **Main outcome:**
- **Activities:**
 - Activity 1:
 - purpose:
 - steps:
 - result:
 - Activity 2:
 - purpose:
 - steps:
 - result:
- **Error or alternate paths:**
- **Concepts involved:**
- **Screens or interactions involved:**
- **Important rules or risks:**

Worked example

Example: customer submits a return request

- **Goal:** a customer requests a return and receives a decision
- **Primary actor:** customer
- **Trigger:** customer decides to return an item from a completed order
- **Main outcome:** return request is approved or rejected
- **Activities:**

- Create request
 - customer selects items and reason
 - system records the request
- Review request
 - system checks policy and eligibility
 - system approves automatically or routes for manual review
- Notify customer
 - system sends the decision
- **Error or alternate paths:**
 - request falls outside the allowed return window
 - request is missing item selection
 - request is rejected because the product is non-returnable
- **Concepts involved:** customer, order, return request, refund decision
- **Screens involved:** order details page, return request form, confirmation/decision screen

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For stories, the handoff should preserve the **narrative and outcome flow**.

The receiver should be able to tell:

- who wants what
- what the happy path is
- where the important exceptions are
- what concepts and screens the story touches

If the notes read like disconnected steps rather than one coherent journey, improve the handoff before transformation.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into a story layer by:

- turning the story into a named business narrative
- turning activities into ordered story activities
- mapping key steps to business operations
- linking actors, concepts, and screens
- separating happy path and error path behavior

You do not need to produce IDs or YAML field names yourself.

Common mistakes

- listing steps without the overall goal
- mixing several unrelated stories together
- describing only the happy path
- naming activities but not the result of each activity
- using UI button names instead of business actions
- forgetting which concepts are affected by the story

